

OXFORD

**INTERNATIONAL
AQA EXAMINATIONS**

INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE LT03

Unit 3 Elements of Crime and Mystery

Mark scheme

June 2023

Version: 1.0 Final



2 3 6 X L T 0 3 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

Further copies of this mark scheme are available from [oxfordaqaexams.org.uk](https://www.oxfordaqaexams.org.uk)

Copyright information

OxfordAQA retains the copyright on all its publications. However, registered schools/colleges for OxfordAQA are permitted to copy material from this booklet for their own internal use, with the following important exception: OxfordAQA cannot give permission to schools/colleges to photocopy any material that is acknowledged to a third party even for internal use within the centre.

Copyright © 2023 Oxford International AQA Examinations and its licensors. All rights reserved.

Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

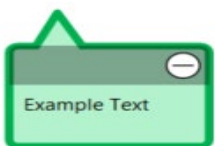
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 7–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Red Line		 Toolbar Tooltip: Red Line		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Unfocused		Toolbar Tooltip: Unfocused		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Factual Inaccuracy		Toolbar Tooltip: Factual Inaccuracy		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 18 years old so we are judging their skills at the end of Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
---	---

William Shakespeare: *Macbeth*

‘Macduff is presented as a traditional avenging hero.’

To what extent do you agree with this view of Macduff’s characterisation?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Macbeth* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Macduff’s discovery of Duncan’s body and his subsequent call to arms
- the murder of Macduff’s wife and children which prompts him to swear revenge
- Macduff killing Macbeth
- the warning to Macbeth to ‘Beware Macduff’
- the connection between Macduff and the prophecy ‘none of woman born’
- Macduff hailing Malcolm as the new king of Scotland.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the religious language used by Macduff in response to Duncan’s murder
- the dialogue between Macduff and Malcolm in 4.3 which takes the form of a planned rebellion
- Macduff’s distress at the news of his wife and children which is presented through a series of pained questions
- the stage direction which details Macduff ‘bearing Macbeth’s head on a pole’
- Macduff’s statement that ‘my voice is in my sword’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	2
---	---

Samuel Taylor Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*

In *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*, Coleridge suggests that there are more terrible things to fear than death.

To what extent do you agree?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Life-in-Death who wins the game and who is more feared by the crew than Death
- the ‘seraph-man’ or angel that appears on the crew’s corpses which implies death is not to be feared
- the horror of the Mariner’s eternal penance
- the deaths of the crew
- the crew who do not rot, and the Mariner’s horror at the ‘curse in a dead man’s eye’
- the death of the albatross which is described as a ‘hellish thing’ and which sets all the subsequent fearful events in motion
- the animated bodies of the ship’s crew sailing the ship as a ‘ghastly crew’.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the inclusion of the shipmates’ dialogue in response to the shooting of the albatross
- the symbolism of the dead albatross hung around the Mariner’s neck
- the horrific descriptions of Life-in-Death’s appearance in contrast to the little said about Death
- the Wedding Guest’s fearful interjections into the Mariner’s narrative which are placed after the deaths of the crew
- the Mariner’s agonised contrast between the living ‘slimy things’ and the death of the ‘many men so beautiful’
- the gothic language and imagery used to present the dead mariners
- the heavenly language and imagery of the ‘seraph-men’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	3
---	---

Robert Browning: *Selected Poems*

‘The crimes in Robert Browning’s poetry are presented as private and personal acts.’

To what extent do you agree?

In your answer, make reference to ‘The Laboratory’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Browning's *Selected Poems* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the speaker in ‘The Laboratory’ who acts out of a private and personal desire for revenge
- the speaker’s choice of weapon: poison
- Porphyria’s murder: strangulation by her own hair in the private setting of the cabin in the woods
- Gauthier’s accusations of having spent the night with the narrator in ‘Count Gismond’
- the implied murder of the Duchess which is not carried out by the Duke: ‘I gave commands’
- the more public acts of crime – the Mayor’s betrayal of the Piper and the Patriot’s ‘year’s misdeeds’.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the privacy of the setting in ‘The Laboratory’
- the sensual listing of Elise’s body parts
- the repeated motif of heads on shoulders in ‘Porphyria’s Lover’
- the lover’s first-person narration which gives access to his private thoughts
- the extended description of intimacy between the faithless cousins and the narrator in Count Gismond: ‘kissed my cheek’, ‘arm in arm’
- the remote description of the crime in ‘My Last Duchess’: eg ‘and then all smiles stopped’
- the public settings of ‘The Patriot’ and ‘The Pied Piper of Hamelin’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	4
---	---

Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist*

‘Children in *Oliver Twist* are presented only as innocent victims.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Oliver Twist* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Oliver’s tears and pleas to the magistrate not to be sold to Mr Gamfield
- Oliver’s treatment by the Sowerberrys, the Bumbles, Fagin and Sikes
- Charley Bates who, despite being exploited by Fagin, ends the novel making ‘an honest living’
- Oliver’s friend at the workhouse, ‘little Dick’: eg ‘they had been beaten, and starved, and shut up together many a time’
- Fagin’s gang and the Artful Dodger who attempt to enlist Oliver into becoming a pick-pocket and who abandon him when he is caught
- Noah Claypole who is a child himself but who victimises Oliver and chooses crime.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Oliver who can be seen as a symbol of incorruptible goodness
- the description of Oliver’s distress when he is taken in front of the Board
- little Dick’s religious blessing to Oliver as he leaves the workhouse
- the ironic descriptions of Fagin as the ‘respectable’ and ‘kindly gentleman’ during the scene where the innocent Oliver is taught to steal via ‘a game’
- the omniscient narration which describes Oliver’s ‘horror’ at the realisation he was to be involved in pick-pocketing and later housebreaking and burglary
- the presentation of Fagin’s gang as skilled and enthusiastic thieves.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 5

Edgar Allan Poe: *Collected Stories*

‘In the short stories of Edgar Allan Poe, the victims’ only significance is in their suffering.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

In your answer, make reference to ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ and at least one other story.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Poe’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the victims in ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ who are incidental victims of random brutality
- the details given about the mother and daughter which imply their significance: eg ‘Madame L told fortunes’, ‘lived an exceedingly retired life’
- the victims in ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ and ‘The Purloined Letter’ who are significant in that their suffering allows Dupin to reveal his cleverness
- the connection between the narrator’s madness and the old man’s ‘vulture eye’ in ‘A Tell-Tale Heart’
- the narrative of ‘The Pit and the Pendulum’ which is literally an exploration in suffering
- the role of the cat in exposing the murder of the narrator’s wife in ‘The Black Cat’.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the dehumanisation in the depiction of the bodies of Madame L’Espanaye and Mademoiselle Camille: ‘the throat’, ‘the deceased’
- the ending of ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ which focuses on Dupin’s battle of wits with the police rather than on justice for the murdered women
- the sailor’s report which reveals the humanity of ‘the old lady’ and ‘the girl’
- the first-person narration of ‘A Tell-Tale Heart’ which reveals the narrator’s obsession with the old man
- Pluto, the black cat, who is eponymous which implies his centrality to the story
- the victim in ‘The Purloined Letter’ who is unnamed but who has been driven to ‘despair’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	6
---	---

Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories*

Discuss the significance of the settings as backdrops for crime in Robert Louis Stevenson's short stories.

Make detailed reference to 'A Lodging for the Night' and at least one other short story in your answer.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Stevenson's *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the house by the graveyard in 'A Lodging for the Night' which is positioned as outside of polite society
- the luxury of Brissetout's house in 'A Lodging for the Night' which contrasts Villon's poverty
- the streets of London and Soho in particular in 'The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde'
- Jekyll's laboratory with its history of being a dissecting room
- Hyde's rooms which reflect the duality within Jekyll
- the darkness and danger of the streets of Edinburgh in 'The Body Snatcher'
- the hallway at the Old George Inn which acts as a spotlight on MacFarlane
- the sinister depiction of the dissecting rooms and the graveyard
- the dealer's shop in 'Markheim'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of place and time as narrative devices
- the 'nightmarish' and 'dingy' depictions of Soho
- the motif of the fog in 'The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde'
- the significance of The Old George Inn being positioned next to the railway station
- gothic imagery used to describe the graveyard and the isolated road to it
- the contrast between the streets of Paris and 'the fine old house'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 7

Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*

Poirot says to Sheppard, ‘You wish to see the affair, not as the family doctor sees it, but with the eye of a detective who knows and cares for no one – to whom they are all strangers and all equally liable to suspicion.’

To what extent do you agree that Christie presents Poirot as treating all of the suspects in *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* equally?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Poirot’s threat to Flora that ‘I shall go through with it to the end’ when she commissions his services
- Poirot’s offering to Sheppard: ‘I am willing to give you the chance of another way out’
- the use of Poirot’s little reunions and gatherings
- Poirot’s treatment of Parker: eg ‘Do not play the farce of the honest, injured man’
- Poirot’s partnership with Sheppard: eg ‘Watson to his Holmes’
- Poirot’s encouraging of the romance between Flora and Blunt
- Poirot’s public revealing of everyone’s secrets.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the paternalistic language Poirot uses with Flora: ‘Papa Poirot’, ‘my dear’
- the repeated universal statements Poirot makes: ‘Each one of you has something to hide’
- the repeated terms of endearment Poirot uses: ‘my friend’, ‘my good Parker’
- the structure of the narrative: moves from one confession/interrogation to another
- the ‘strain of weakness’ speech
- Poirot’s sympathetic language: ‘Life was not very easy for that mother and daughter’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 8

Qiu Xiaolong: *Death of a Red Heroine*

'At the end of *Death of a Red Heroine* there is little sense that justice has been delivered.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Red Heroine* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Guo who agrees to testify to 'save his own neck' and who 'committed no murder' but who is executed alongside Wu
- the most serious charge that Wu faces which is not Guan's murder, but 'crime and corruption under Western bourgeois influence'
- Wu Bing's arrest and immediate execution which exceeds even Yu and Chen's 'best scenario'
- the taking over of Yu and Chen's case by the Party's 'Internal Security', depriving them of 'the satisfaction of closing the case'
- Chen's assertion to his mother that, politics aside, 'justice was served'
- the absence of any recognition of Guan's suffering from the observers or the newspapers.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the focalised narrative which reveals Chen's thoughts: 'he was supposed to seek justice by punishing the murderer'
- the repetition of the assertion that 'everything has been done in the Party's interests'
- the dialogue used to inform Chen second-hand that 'Wu's on trial today'
- the inclusion of the passage from People's Daily which is clearly ironic
- Chen's rhetorical question: 'had Wu been punished for the crime he had committed?'
- the irony that Chen only solved the case due to 'his own carnal connection with a politburo member's daughter'.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	9
---	---

Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?*

‘In *When Will There Be Good News?*, heroes come in all shapes and sizes.’

To what extent do you agree that the presentation of heroes in *When Will There Be Good News?* defies traditional conventions of crime writing?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *When Will There Be Good News?* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Reggie Chase: the ‘girl detective’ and her saving of Jackson after the train crash
- Joanna Hunter: the ‘dangerous avenging angel’
- Sadie and Scout – the canine heroes
- Aunt Debbie and Gabrielle Mason whose actions as mothers are heroic
- Jackson who is a typical hero of a crime narrative, relentless, flawed and outside of the authorities
- Marcus’s death which is described as heroic.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Louise’s focalised narrative with its focus on heroism: ‘give a medal to all the women’
- the ending of the novel which focuses on the name of Joanna’s dog
- the imagery of Reggie ‘saturated’ with Jackson’s blood after she saved his life
- the newspaper reporting about Marcus: eg “‘Hero Policeman’ and so on’
- the ‘magic words’ that Jackson can’t resist: ‘They need your help’
- descriptions of Joanna’s career in contrast to her killing of the henchmen: eg ‘She became a doctor because she wanted to help people’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.